

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] Okay. Already recording. I will quickly show you. I will share the screen really quickly to show you a commitment form, which is an official document where you give me permission again now that it is being recorded. I will explain it really quickly. Along with this authorization, there is also the way we can store this. Not only your information here from the interview. You will basically be able to choose the option. So I will show you here very quickly, you will understand. Are you able to see it? So this is our consent form. As it was already written, we are conducting an exploratory study called Multicultural Investigation on the Conceptualization and Measurement of Relationship Quality. And here we have, if you agree to participate. The interview should last around 40 minutes and is voluntary. You can interrupt the interview at any time if you no longer wish to participate. So here you give me your response. I give my consent for the interview audio to be recorded. Yes, yes. And here we have two options. As I told you, I agree with how the data will be shared. We have two options, basically the first, which is the complete transcription of everything that is being said, except for sensitive information that may be shared during the interview. There will be some more sensitive questions that you may or may not answer at the time. And anyway, you can choose to change this option after the interview, as you will be able to review the questions afterward, or you also have the option that all transcribed excerpts can be shared. You will not be identified. Actually, it's not written here, but in the first option, you will not be identified either, okay? The difference is that in the second everything can be transcribed and shared. And in the first, everything except the sensitive information. Then you can make a choice now, and if anything, change it at the end of the interview. Do you have any preference?

Speaker 2 [00:02:23] For now, the first option.

Speaker 1 [00:02:25] The first option, okay, quickly. Before all this, I also wanted to ask you to send me your email. It can be here on [Social Media], where we talked, or by email, or anyway, send a message so I can save your email to send you this form here, and then you can mark the document here for me, saved in yes and with your signature here below, as shown, because I need this document, can it be? And then right after the interview, I'll send it to you.

Speaker 2 [00:02:59] Okay, I sent it through [Social Media].

Speaker 1 [00:03:01] Okay. Thank you! I will stop sharing this screen here. And we can start the interview itself. I will start then with some more basic questions about you. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:03:17] [16-20] years.

Speaker 1 [00:03:18] [16-20]. How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:03:27] About [<1 year] and a few days and weeks.

Speaker 1 [00:03:33] And do you have children?

Speaker 2 No.

Speaker 1 Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:03:41] With my dad, my mom, my sister, and my dogs.

Speaker 1 [00:03:46] What is your main source of income? And what is your current occupation?

Speaker 2 [00:03:51] I am just a [Occupation]; my parents support me.

Speaker 1 [00:03:59] I understand. And, well, before starting the questions about your partner, how would you like me to refer to her? Can it be partner, girlfriend, wife, companion?

Speaker 2 [00:04:15] Girlfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:04:16] Girlfriend? Okay, starting on this part. Regarding you two, can you tell me more or less how your love story was? Remember, the more details you can give me, not just in this question, but regarding everything, the better. Pass on information if you can, and of course, if you feel comfortable, okay?

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:05:24] Oh, I understand. So it basically started at that meeting, right? And well, how would you compare the quality of your relationship to that of your friends? From what you see?

Speaker 2 [00:05:46] Like. I have the impression that my friends, right? We have a more or less aligned relationship concerning responsibilities, you know? Like effective responsibility. Like, always trying to talk and such and maintain a relatively healthy relationship, you know? Even with sometimes conflicts and such, I imagine it's more or less along those lines, both mine and my friends. You understand?

Speaker 1 [00:06:11] And could you tell me more or less what you think justifies why it is healthy like that? What characteristics do you see as healthy?

Speaker 2 [00:06:25] In mine specifically?

Speaker 1 [00:06:29] Yes, in relation to it too. But also your friends since you used the same word to refer to them.

Speaker 2 [00:06:39] I think maybe a bit of the openness that we have to improve, you know? Thinking also about our [topic] course, we have, I think, this search, this greater intention to have this care, you know, with things that are not so tangible. So, for example, taking care of the other and really wanting it to work, you know? I think it's a bit of that. Like being sensitive to the vulnerabilities of both the other and ourselves, you know? Like, not being too rigid, but being more flexible, open, talkative, these things.

Speaker 1 [00:07:13] So, like, from what I understand, the similarity is because you are studying psychology. There is?

Speaker 2: I think so.

Speaker 1: And do you mind telling me how many romantic partners you have had?

Speaker 2 [00:07:30] Officially, she is the first. But, but before her, I had been with a girl once, like at parties, you know? Like at a party, I was with someone, but with a more extended conversation and such, a fling, so to speak, and there was another girl. But. But it wasn't a very good experience.

Speaker 1 [00:07:53] I understand. Understood. How would you compare the quality of your current relationship to your previous relationships at the time? More or less from what you said, it was more officially like that. This includes what we can say about cases. Anyway, you've already had.

Speaker 2 [00:08:26] How do I compare with the others?

Speaker 1 [00:08:27] Yes, with the previous ones.

Speaker 2 [00:08:30] I think in this one I feel safe, you know? Like, both to, to express and be who I am, you know? I don't feel so much the need to show strength all the time, you know? I think she is very welcoming in the sense that sometimes we are not on our best days, or sometimes. I don't know. Like, there's a part of me that is really buried, you know? But she still has the patience, like, everything that being together, we are discovering little by little and in our own relationship. I think there was the intention too. Both were on the same vibe, you know? I think that makes a big difference. Like, it's not a matter of being at the same level of feeling 100% of the time, but we are always accommodating each other, you know? Like, it's something that goes on and works, you know? Because there is the collaboration of both at the same time.

Speaker 1 [00:09:24] I understood, yes. And for you, what do you think makes a relationship high quality and low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:09:35] High quality? I think flexibility. And understanding. Low quality would be a bit of the opposite, like suffocating or wanting a response too much. Not too much response in fact, but demanding things from another person that could be natural. For example, complaining that something isn't natural and already demanding it on top of that. I think that's not right.

Speaker 1 [00:10:02]: Could you give me a more specific example? Please. Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:10:09]: For example, like sending a message and I can't respond because I'm busy or something like that, and the person keeps messaging, insisting on a quick response, starting to think it's a lack of feeling, that you're being inconsiderate, but you're just busy, you know? I think that's an example.

Speaker 1 [00:10:32]: I understand. You also mentioned a lot about the issue of security, of having a strong relationship. You used these words, and can you tell me approximately when you think your relationship was strong or secure? Can you give me an example?

Speaker 2 [00:10:54]: I think it strengthened over time. For example, I think the moments that were more complicated, like how the family welcomed or did not welcome us in certain situations. I think sometimes we reached a point where we thought, "Hey, let's stop here so we don't have to distort a good story, to avoid too much strain." Or we agree that our intention is really to continue and face these things. So, I think this moment of conversation is about transparency. And I think over time, we increasingly have more transparency in communicating and talking about how we feel, what we miss, or not. I think that's when it strengthens, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:11:43]: I understand. So, would you say that communication is important in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:48]: And clarity.

Speaker 1 [00:11:50]: Understand. And for you, what would you consider most important in a relationship? And?

Speaker 2 [00:12:07]: I think affection. And transparency.

Speaker 1 [00:12:15]: It seems to align with what you've already commented on, about security and such. Why do you think these would be your answers? Would it be affection and transparency?

Speaker 2 [00:12:34]: As for affection, because increasingly I see myself as someone who really likes contact, you know, being of service or feeling that I'm receiving affection and support. That's something that is very important to me. And transparency, because I find it very annoying when, sometimes when someone is in a different vibe, people can't understand each other about it. "Hey, you're in this vibe, it's quite different from mine. Let's talk about it, if necessary, we rehearse here or we readjust and adapt." Because I think that's much better than procrastinating, pretending to be something you're not, you know? I prefer transparency.

Speaker 1 [00:13:21]: Understand. And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:13:30]: Well.. I don't know. I've never had exactly the words to write about it. I've always been someone who writes a lot, but defining love is a big challenge. I think it's a sense of well-being, you know? Oh, I know, I'll take a page from a book by Machado de Assis that I once saw, which I thought was exactly what it is. I think it's from *Memórias Póstumas de Brás Cubas*, which has a page full of ellipses, which is basically a conversation that the couple has after sex. And they're like... It's so emotional, but so emotional that words can't contain it, just a bunch of ellipses. Sometimes it transcends words, you know? I think that would be more or less it in a more poetic way, but in practice, I think it's more about support and nurturing, trial and error, but persistence, you know? And an intention to be together. I think that's more or less it.

Speaker 1 [00:14:39]: Isn't it cool? But how important is love for you in a relationship?

Speaker 2: Quite important. Does it need development? I think I couldn't.

Speaker 1 [00:14:54]: You can unfold it if you want.

Speaker 2 [00:14:56]: I don't think it's just that. It's quite important to me.

Speaker 1 [00:15:01]: And how do you know that your partner, that your girlfriend loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:15:08]: I think so. Not just by what she says, but also by the considerate details, you know? And sometimes talking about her past experiences and saying that this time it's different, both her disposition and the way she also feels loved, you know? So, I think it's a mutual exchange.

Speaker 1 [00:15:32]: Do you think it's more about the exchange, then, especially yours?

Speaker 2 [00:15:37]: And willingness. The exchange and willingness.

Speaker 1 [00:15:38]: Well, we enter here into a category that deals a little more with the idea of conflict in the relationship. What would be the challenges you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:01]: I think it's myself, because sometimes I feel like I should... I should embrace myself more and sometimes, the somewhat rigid relationship I have with myself ends up reflecting in the relationship I have with my girlfriend, you know? And with other people too. So I often see that at the moment when I am very weakened and I think maybe it's better to distance myself, you know? I think that's the biggest challenge, kind of putting my foot down in the decision to face it with her. But at the same time, the challenge of not reflecting so much on her is something that... that is turbulent within me. My own things, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:16:42]: Understand. And you? Is it your girlfriend? Do you have disagreements or difficulties in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:00]: I think it's that sometimes the way we... our way of enjoying things is different. Like, she likes to have fun at parties and stay out late and those kinds of things, hanging out and spending the night at friends houses, and I'm more introverted, you know? Like, I prefer to be quieter. I trust that she does things she likes without the parties and that she respects our relationship even when she's at parties. But it's something that's different, you know? Sometimes it causes conflict, sometimes not. And another thing too, I think that even though we value communication a lot, sometimes communication itself is the challenge, you know? Like, communicating is sometimes a challenge in itself.

Speaker 1 [00:17:41]: No. And how often does this happen?

Speaker 2 [00:17:55]: I think it's about once a week, more or less like that. Sometimes it's a small thing, sometimes like, "Oh, you took too long to reply to me," face to face, you know?

Because, for example, sometimes I think a conflict issue is having different expectations. An example, these days she made a statement and I was like, "Wow, thank you so much," I didn't even imagine this type of statement, but actually her expectation was that I would reciprocate instantly, you know? "Wow, I also think the same way," but it wasn't what was happening, you know? Like, I was more distant, you know? Like, it wasn't as coincident as she was saying. I think that sometimes, this different expectation that she wanted me to react quickly and say the same thing, and in my head, I... I welcome your statement, you know? I thank and welcome it very much.

Speaker 1 [00:18:53]: And besides this difference in expectation, would you say that... What are these differences about?

Speaker 2 [00:19:09]: I think sometimes about some interests. And tastes, you know? But it's a matter that we also hold on to. Like, it's more about taste, you know? For example, she really likes to dance. She dances a lot. I don't have a specific hobby, so I support her a lot in her pursuits, like dancing, etc. And she also supports mine when I have any interests. Yes, she supports a lot, but it's that sometimes I feel like she spends more time with these things, or like these big passions of hers take up time that could be with me too, you know? Like, sometimes it seems that time isn't well balanced, but it's something we handle well, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:19:55]: And what are other ways you use to maintain your relationship besides these strategies that you mentioned?

Speaker 2 [00:20:09]: We mostly keep in touch through messaging, calls, memes, those things.

Speaker 1 [00:20:19]: Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:20:20]: And when we notice we're more distant or something like that, we try to have some good time together, dating, something like that, to reconnect, to understand, like a conversation in person, something like that.

Speaker 1 [00:20:32]: So improving communication, right? So would you say your relationship is good for you? And why?

Speaker 2 [00:20:42]: I think it's good. I think it's really good because it's exactly that, I feel secure and like, I think there's synergy, so to speak, you know? I think we get along very well, you know? Because we support each other and such. I think that's very important to me. And it ends up that another thing that influences a lot is that we understand each other well in how we show love, you know? We're very touchy, talking about these things, which is very important.

Speaker 1 [00:21:12]: I see. Can you give me an example from daily life of this thing, of how you, as you said, give that touch, give that love?

Speaker 2 [00:21:25]: It's like, usually our routines don't match very well, so that's also a bit of a challenge, you know? We don't see each other much and the fact that we really like physical

touch, so it ends up being a real conflict. But... But we always... We manage to see each other at least a couple of times a week and then it's all about love and hugs, things like that. Contact.

Speaker 1 [00:21:52]: Yes. And do you believe your relationship has changed something in you? And how?

Speaker 2 [00:22:03]: I think so. This constant effort to dissect communication and not be explosive when angry, you know? Because sometimes when we speak when we're angry, we end up regretting it. So, like, sometimes we explode and then we're fine, sorry. So, to avoid this explosion and having to apologize, like for something that could have been avoidable, I think sometimes you need to take time to clear your head and take care of that person, you know? To take care of the relationship as if it were something of our own, because really this vibe, like, I think having this care...

Speaker 1 [00:22:46]: Do you believe your girlfriend has also changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:53]: Yes. She... She used to say that before, because for her it was always very difficult, you know? Like speaking up when something is bothering her or something like that. And she used to say that before she used to just stay quiet, not talk about it and kind of change the way she treated the person without speaking or doing what was happening. And in our relationship she has already improved a lot in this, she communicates much better and is much easier to understand and stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:23:20]: That's nice. Moving on to another part. You affirmed to me "Yes", and since you feel secure in your mind. But can you explain to me what makes you feel secure? More concrete examples like this? I mean, like it can also give you a feeling of security or insecurity. It can happen too.

Speaker 2 [00:24:03]: I feel like I'm not walking on eggshells when I talk about feelings, when I talk about what's going on with me, you know? This is something that was very contrasting with the last person I was with because, well, the last person talked about everything. Yes, she was very open and I felt completely suffocated. And I could already see from the beginning that the other person was much more involved than I was, and that was a novelty for me because usually I'm the one more involved, you know? It's like this thing of changing positions, changing from being the one who is less involved. It was something different for me because usually my space was the other person's, so changing positions was something that, wow, I already know what it's like to be in that position and not be very well, not be very reciprocal with another person. But then I don't want to be as rude as it was to me in both times, you know? Like people who were in the position of not being reciprocal. I wanted to be more careful and the way I found to be careful is by being clear and speaking, I don't think it's like that. I think that, like, I can't be the point you would like it to be is. And I didn't manage to open up very well with the other person, you know? I felt very suffocated because it was what she already talked about, that it was very dense and sometimes I took a lot of other people's pain. So, like, I was very. And with my girlfriend, no. I feel like she has this look when she's talking to me that is very welcoming, you know? It's a very... The first time to her, I talked nonstop like this, and it had been a long

time since I couldn't talk nonstop with someone, you know? I mean in relationships with friends it goes, but in terms of romantic relationship I was already very locked, because the last relationship I had. And, I think that's the security issue because it was.

Speaker 1 [00:26:03]: So, like not feeling suffocated in a current relationship makes you feel more comfortable too, right? Understood. Well, [Participant's Name], now quickly I'm going to pass it on. I'm going to show you some scales and ask a few questions. And well, this part is very quick. Then I will return, but you will understand as soon as I open it. We have here the first sentence that I'm presenting to you. "My girlfriend really listens to me" being from 1 here on the scale like nothing from the true to 9 completely true. How much would you agree with that sentence? And then you can indicate one?

Speaker 2 [00:26:55]: Very true, 7.

Speaker 1 [00:26:58]: Number 7. Okay. And again in relation to this sentence. "My girlfriend has been worried about my stats". Same thing from 1 nothing true And 9, completely true. What number would you give me?

Speaker 2: Seven.

Speaker 1: Seven, too?. Okay. And can you explain why you chose seven for the first sentence?

Speaker 2 [00:27:21]: Because I think it's really true, but it doesn't quite reach completely because I think it's always a challenge. It's not a guaranteed thing. But. But it's a constant attempt.

Speaker 1 [00:27:33]: I see. And about the second sentence that you also gave 7. Can you explain why?

Speaker 2 [00:27:43]: It's the same thing, it's also a constant attempt. It's not a guarantee, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:27:50]: Can you give me an example of this constant challenge? Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:27:59]: I think she's very open when I talk about things, you know? It's a challenge and I think that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:28:18]: Understood.

Speaker 2 [00:28:20]: Let's accept that it gets 7 for a margin of error.

Speaker 1 [00:28:25]: And this one has an accuracy. Until I'll stop transmitting this screen and I'll return to standard questions. And this part is going to be a drive. We only have two little questions and it's a part that like this, if you feel comfortable, you know, you can tell me if you

want, but there are some questions now about your intimacy. So, if you're not in the mood, we can skip this part. So it's just two little questions. The first one you have had sexual relations lately?

Speaker 2 [00:29:05]: Yes. But not so much.

Speaker 1 [00:29:06]: And how satisfied are you with your sex life? And why do you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:29:16]: I think this is still new to me, you know? And it's still very internalized. These things of... In society we think of something like shame in female pleasure, something kind of taboo like that, you know? I try to demystify with this and thank God I find a lot of competent people talking and demystifying these things. But for me, it's still a question, you know? It's like, little by little, you understand? It's like, feeling secure with myself and this is reflected.

Speaker 1 [00:29:53]: And would you include sex as something important in the relationship, like other things you mentioned, such as communication, affection?

Speaker 2 [00:30:03]: I think it can be important. But... But I don't see it yet as something that important because I still feel a bit blocked, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:30:16]: I understand. And I'll return shortly to get your response again for the scales. Let me go back here. Well, as I mentioned, we have this question here: How satisfied are you with your relationship? And could you indicate which option fits you best among these seven?

Speaker 2 [00:30:46]: Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:30:49]: Wich? I didn't hear you. Apologize for it.

Speaker 2 [00:30:50]: Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:30:52]: Very satisfied. Okay. Based on your response, how would you rate your satisfaction in this relationship? On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 is not satisfied at all and 10 is completely satisfied, where would you place the number according to your response?

Speaker 2 [00:31:14]: Eight.

Speaker 1 [00:31:15]: Number eight. Can you tell me more or less why you chose eight and not, for example, ten for completely or closer to zero and not satisfied?

Speaker 2 [00:31:27]: Of course, there's always space for improvement, you know? And "completely"intimidated me, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:31:37]: Understand. These are two extremes here. Well, I'll stop sharing the screen again, okay?? We're almost done with the interview, and I even noticed here some things you said, right? But I caught a few words, and you mentioned the importance of

communication in moments of security and the importance of being healthy, of flexibility, of being also in the same vibe. Affection, transparency, and the importance of contact for you as well. You say you really like contact, exchange, willingness, and the importance as you said of avoiding explosions even in the relationship, right? And you had said that at the beginning too, I found that very interesting, including this one that you think it tends to fit because you have the same vibe, the characteristic of you having the similarity in the [topic] course.

Speaker 2 [00:32:44]: Sorry. The similarity of [Major] graduation is in relation to my my friends. She courses [Major], actually.

Speaker 1 [00:32:52]: Ah, okay. I thought she also did. And you were also referring to both of you. Understand. Well, anyway, considering all this, I wanted to ask you if you would like to add anything, anything I didn't ask, anything that's not included that you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:33:10]: No, I think it's okay, I like it a lot, I thought it was cool and good.

Speaker 1 [00:33:15]: So I want to thank you for participating. Well, remembering again. I think you remember at the beginning I showed you those two options of how information can be stored. You had chosen the option to transcribe the excerpts, except for those more sensitive parts that you can see in the interview. If you want to keep this option, if you want to change, feel free now. Then I finally go.

Speaker 2 [00:33:43]: Does it make a difference in research?

Speaker 1 [00:33:45]: Sorry?

Speaker 2 [00:33:46]: It makes a lot of difference in research and data collection?

Speaker 1 [00:33:50]: Actually, no. We're also trying to understand which option most of the people being interviewed prefer. In this case, the information will be stored and everything will be anonymous anyway. But it doesn't make that much difference.

Speaker 2 [00:34:07]: So, you can still maintain the option in the first.

Speaker 1 [00:34:11]: Okay. Well, I'll send you that fear of talking to consent for you to mark for me to change with the signature and finally, I want to thank you again for participating. And I'll ask you just one little thing, how we're conducting our interviews. I would like that if you could indicate two people close to me so that I can talk to these people and indicate and ask for indications of LGBT couples so that I can interview. So if you have a contact that you imagine, that knows LGBT couples who are willing to participate in the interview, I'll contact them to ask for these couples. Do you have anything in mind? You can send me by [Social Media] if you prefer?

Speaker 2 [00:34:55]: I'm without anyone right now. I don't know.

Speaker 1 [00:34:57]: Well, if you can think, anyway, anyone close to you, that you know, or can get to know an LGBT couple who would like to be interviewed, it will be very good here for us. So and then there's anything you already send me now I get in touch and explain about it. But I think it's good. Anyway, sometimes it's a bit, but even I took a long time to understand, but I need. If you suggest someone again for me to talk to that person and ask for a couple and an indication of an LGBT couple to be interviewed. But I think it's good for a good. So if you get in touch and all that, if you can mention, even better so that I don't send a message so, looking like being well there to inform that you made the interview and I'll ask the couple, basically. Okay?

Speaker 2 [00:35:46]: Is there a forecast for when the research results would come out? Something like that that I have an interest in seeing later how it is.

Speaker 1 [00:35:53]: Wow, I think it will take a little while because it's research being conducted in the Philippines, the Netherlands, France, here in Brazil, the United States, the principal investigator, who is a Filipino there, anyway, it's a very complex thing, but it's not an idea yet. But anything like that I inform you. Including I already warned that probably we will still have a certificate of who participated. And then if I can get a certificate, it's still not guaranteed. I sent you such a name for everyone I have, so it is.

Speaker 2 [00:36:22]: Excellent.

Speaker 1 [00:36:23]: So okay. Thank you, [Participant's Name]. Bye!

Speaker 2 [00:36:29]: Bye.